

Facilitator Script — First Session with a Participant

For whoever sits with a participant the first time they use Gap Sense. Follow it in order so every participant gets the same introduction. About 25 minutes.

Participants may be blind, low-vision, or DeafBlind. Say everything out loud. Do not point. Put the phone in their hand and guide their fingers when asked.

Before they arrive (5 min)

- Gap Sense installed on their phone, or on a loaner phone.
 - In Accessibility: **Vibrate on cue** on. For a DeafBlind participant, set output to **Visual only, with no sound** and rely on vibration.
 - Volume at about two-thirds. Silent switch position does not matter.
 - Phone screen locks set to **Never** for the session, so the app does not go dark mid-exercise.
 - A clear floor space of at least 10 metres for Part 1, or a measured corridor.
 - This script, and the participant's consent form if your study uses one.
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1. Welcome (2 min)

Say:

“This app helps you learn how long your own street crossing takes. Not in seconds. As a feeling in your body. It will never tell you a number. It plays sounds and vibrations instead. There are no right or wrong answers today. We are only interested in what you notice.”

2. Learn the three signals (3 min)

Open **Accessibility**, press **Test haptic pulse**. Say, as each plays:

“One knock. That is your own tap played back.” “Three knocks. That means you were close enough.” “One long buzz. That means you were too far off.”

Play it twice more. Ask:

“Can you tell the three apart by touch alone?”

Record the answer: yes / no / partly. If no, try the phone in a different grip or against the wrist, and note what helped.

For hearing participants, also open **Help**, then **Run the sound tutorial**, and repeat with sounds.

3. Part 1, Measure my crossing (6 min)

Walk them to the start mark. Say:

“Hold the phone. Press the big button when you step off. Press again at the middle. Press again when you arrive. I will tell you where the middle is.”

Three walks. After each, the app plays their time back. Say:

“That sound is the length of your crossing. Listen to how long it is.”

Do not comment on speed. Do not mention seconds.

4. Part 2, Practise my timing (6 min)

Sit down. Say:

“Press the button. Imagine stepping off. Wait as long as you think your crossing takes. Press again. Then listen to the space between the sounds.”

Let them do at least eight attempts. After the fourth, ask:

“Are you counting, or feeling?”

If counting, say:

“Try to stop counting. Think of the walk instead. The feeling is the point.”

Note roughly how many attempts until the three-knock signal becomes common.

5. Part 3, Compare practice (4 min)

Say:

“You will hear a car’s warning time as a sound. Decide if it is shorter than your crossing, about the same, or longer. Press the matching button.”

Six to ten rounds. Note anything they say out loud about how they decide.

6. Wrap-up questions (3 min)

Ask and write down the answers in their own words:

1. “Which signal was easiest to feel? Which was hardest?”
2. “Did anything in the app confuse you?”
3. “Would you use this on your own, at home? Why or why not?”
4. “Is there anything you wish it did?”

Thank them. Remind them the app is theirs to keep practising with.

Common problems

What happens	What to do
No vibration	Accessibility, check Vibrate on cue is on. On iPhone, confirm it is the installed app, not Safari.
No sound	Volume buttons. The silent switch does not mute the app.
Buttons locked	Part 1 has not been done. Do three walks first.
App will not open after some weeks	TestFlight build expired. Tap the invite link again, press Install.
Screen reader talks over the sounds	Normal. The app quietens the screen reader during playback on purpose.

What to send back to the research team

For each participant, in one message or spreadsheet row:

- date, participant code, phone type
- three-signals-by-touch: yes / no / partly, plus what helped
- attempts until “within margin” became common in Part 2
- the four wrap-up answers, verbatim where possible
- anything that broke, with the exact words on screen